

look at online storage as an option.

After nearly winking out of existence following the dotcom bust, online storage is back. Earlier, users had to deal with a simple web based upload that was slow as well as erratic. No more. Online storage solutions are increasingly sophisticated with many of them providing custom upload applets, Web APIs for integration with other applications, and RSS feeds for publishing updates. There are hundreds of online storage solutions catering to every mix of user needs. Since we are interested in sharing files with others, the solution that you finally pick should offer file sharing with friends as well as the general public. Some of the ones which caught our eye are:

Streamload (www.streamload.com)

With a whopping 25 GB of free storage, Streamload just falls behind Multiply which offers unlimited free storage. There are some restrictions on monthly download (max 10 MB per file, max 100 MB per month) but for the beginning file sharer this can be more than sufficient.

Box.net (www.box.net)

Offers 1 GB of free space with no upload or download restrictions. We really liked the feature of being able to e-mail a link of your file for download by public with the option of password protection. You will need to be premium user (read paid!) to use this feature. Premium users also have private sharing, that is, sharing with other box.net users.

Allmydata (www.allmydata.com)

Uses a slightly different approach by giving you 1 GB of free online storage for every 10 GB of storage you give them from your hard disk. The hard disk space you give them is used as a virtual distributed RAID network hard disk.

eSnips (www.esnips.com)

Similar to box.net, this one gives you 1 GB of storage for all your